

Reading Journal VIII - SEIII

Reading Journal 8

Please write a short reflection about what you read this week. No matter which track, please include the following:

1. Title _____
2. Author _____
3. Reflection: _____

Include a brief summary of the main points along with your thoughts/observations/feelings. What did you learn? What was interesting about this reading? (150 words)

1. **Track One: Extensive Reading - Fiction.** Please choose a new work of fiction. It could be a novel OR a series of short stories. The novel can be any genre (adventure, mystery, historical fiction, romance, sci-fi, classic literature, etc. Obviously, your choice(s) must be in English.
2. **Track Two: Extensive Reading - Non-Fiction.** Please choose work of non-fiction. It could be a book OR a series of academic articles. The book can be about any subject (history, science, geography, philosophy, etc.) Obviously, your choice(s) must be in English.
3. **Track Three - Textbook.** You can also choose to complete readings from our textbook. These should be readings we HAVE NOT done in class. Narrow down the list to four text passages.

Due Sunday, December 7th by 21:00.

Track II

- **Title:** Being Logical: A Guide to Good Thinking
- **Author:** D. Q. McNerny
- **Reflection:**

I think the most practical and useful lesson is how language affects conclusions. For instance, ambiguity: the river bank vs. lender bank, amphiboly: 'Visiting relatives can be boring.' can be understand as two ways. What's more, we should make the charge more measurable and testable, like transform 'This policy is unfair!' to 'This fee rises 20% for A but 5% for B'. Plus, I also spotted another pitfall called loaded questions, like 'Have you stopped wasting water?', which has already assumed guilt. And for applying the principle of charity, we should restate the opposing view in its strongest, clearest form before replying. Then, McNerny's simple fix, prefer plain nouns and active verbs, also helped a lot, which made the conversation more clear and understandable. All these measures will help us walk onto the shortest path to accuracy and respect effectively.